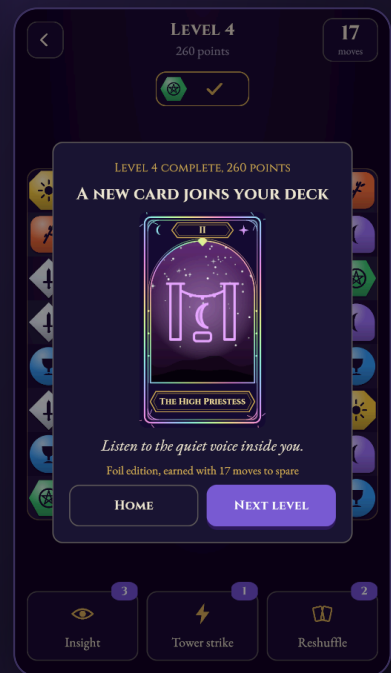
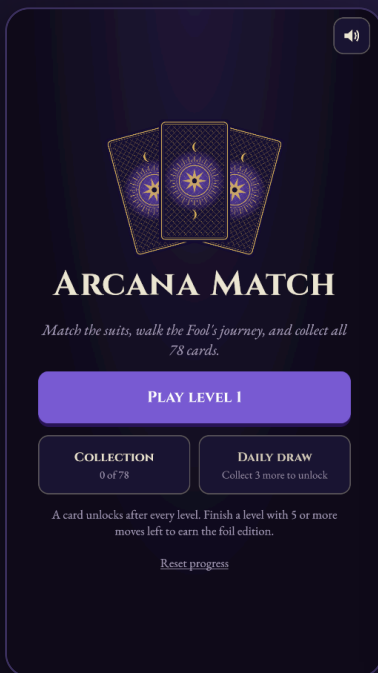




GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT · V1.0

ARCANA MATCH

Match the suits, walk the Fool's journey, and collect all 78 cards.



GENRE

Match-3 puzzle with a card-collection meta

PLATFORM

iOS and Android (portrait), mobile web build

ENGINE

Unity 6 · C#

AUTHOR

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DATE

September 2026

ARCANA MATCH

A tarot-themed match-3 for portrait phones, from concept to a playable build.

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1 · OVERVIEW AND PITCH

A calm, card-collecting match-3. Every level you win adds a tarot card to your deck; once you own three, you can draw one of your own cards each day as a small morning ritual.

THE GAME AT A GLANCE

GENRE	Casual match-3 puzzle with a tarot card-collection meta layer
PLATFORMS	iOS and Android phones, portrait; a mobile web build for playtests
SESSION	1 to 3 minutes per level; a daily ritual of about 30 seconds
AUDIENCE	Casual puzzle players, 25 to 45, who enjoy calm games and collecting; tarot and astrology fans the genre rarely targets
HOOK	Every level you win gives you a tarot card to keep, each with a one-line insight
BUSINESS MODEL	Free to play. Rewarded ads and small purchases for extra moves and boosters (designed, not active)
CONTENT	8 x 8 board, 6 tile types, 5 special tiles, 3 boosters, 78 cards, an endless difficulty curve
STATUS	Playable vertical slice in Unity 6: all systems in, 106 automated rule tests, Android and web builds

How this document relates to the build. Everything marked **LIVE** is in the playable build. Items marked **PROPOSED** are designed and have code hooks, but are not switched on. Numbers in the balancing chapter come from the game's own rules, run by a bot, not from estimates.

PILLARS AND AUDIENCE

Four rules that every feature was checked against.

1

READABLE AT A GLANCE

Every tile differs in colour *and* shape and carries a glyph, so the board reads in sunlight and for colour-blind players.

In the game: Six silhouettes: rounded square, circle, diamond, hexagon, arch, octagon.

2

EVERY WIN GIVES YOU SOMETHING TO KEEP

The reward for a level is a card with art and a line of insight, not just stars and points.

In the game: 78-card deck, foil editions for skilful wins, a collection screen that fills visibly.

3

GENTLE, NOT PUNISHING

Mistakes cost nothing and dead ends are the game's fault, never the player's.

In the game: Free invalid swaps, automatic reshuffle, a once-per-attempt rescue, no energy system, kind texts.

4

SATISFYING FEEDBACK

Every action answers with motion, light, particles and sound, timed to feel snappy.

In the game: Tuned timings in one asset; chimes that climb a scale with each cascade.

TARGET PLAYER

Primary: casual mobile puzzle players (roughly 25 to 45) who play in short breaks, like a sense of progress and enjoy collecting. They know match-3 conventions and expect them to work.

Secondary: players drawn to tarot, astrology and "cosy" aesthetics. The theme and the daily draw give them a reason to open a puzzle game they might otherwise pass by.

WHAT THEY WANT

- A game they can put down at any moment without losing anything.
- Visible progress that isn't just a level number.
- A calm mood: no timers, no shouting, no punishment.
- Something to look forward to tomorrow.

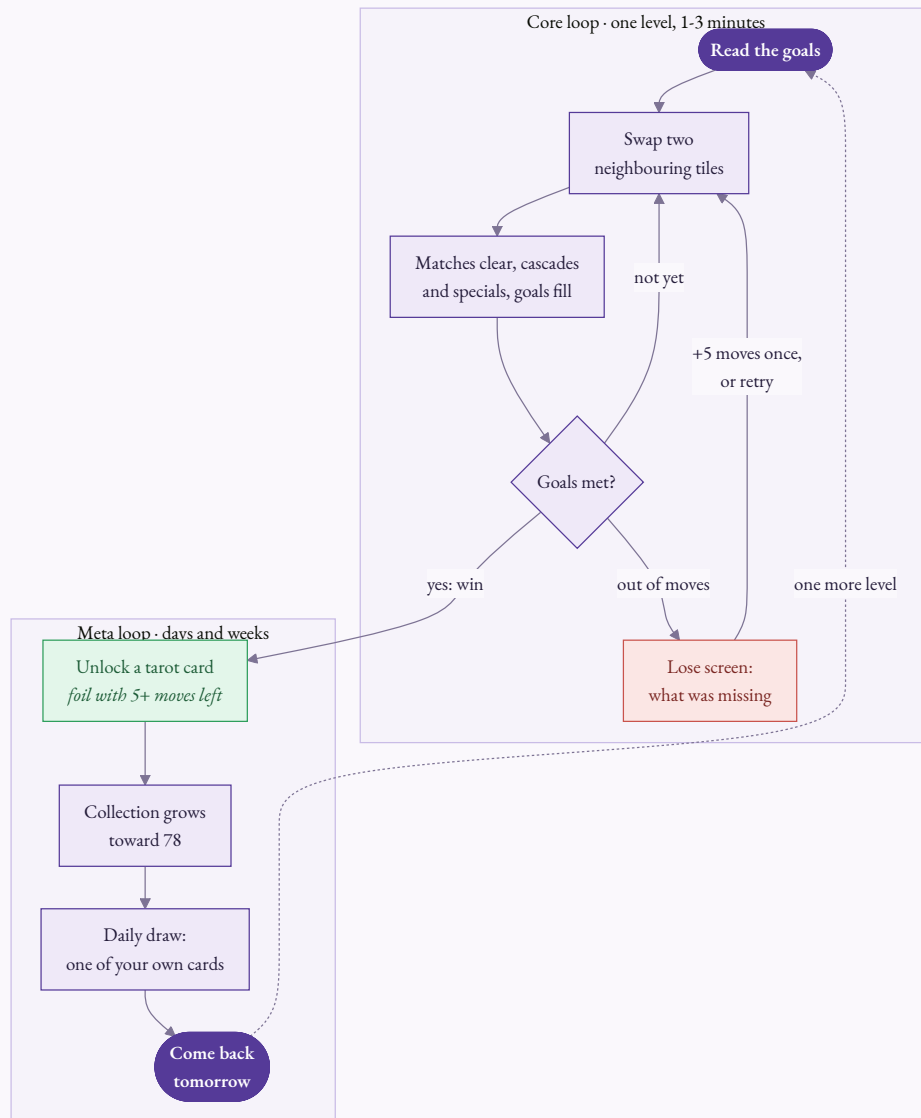
POSITIONING

TYPICAL MATCH-3		ARCANA MATCH
Reward for a level	Stars, coins, a map step	A tarot card with art and an insight; foil for mastery
Reason to return	Lives refill, events, streaks	One daily draw from your own deck, with no streak to lose
Tone	Loud and bright	Night-sky palette, glass-bell sounds, reflective texts
Stuck boards	Often costs a life or a booster	Always reshuffled for free
Readability	Often colour only	Colour, shape and glyph on every tile

The design deliberately keeps genre conventions (8 x 8 board, swipe to swap, lines and specials, move limits) so the game is instantly familiar, and puts its originality into the reward, the theme and the tone.

CORE AND META LOOPS

The core loop is the moment-to-moment puzzle; the meta loop is the reason to play one more level and to come back tomorrow.



CORE LOOP

- **Read** the goal pills (for example *30 Wands + 17 Cups*) and the move counter.
- **Swap** two neighbours by swipe or tap-tap. Only swaps that make a match are accepted.
- **Resolve**: matches clear, goals count up live, tiles fall and cascade, specials form and chain.
- **Decide** again, with boosters as optional tools. A level lasts 18 to 24 moves.

META LOOP

- Each win **unlocks a card**; winning with 5+ moves left makes it **foil**.
- The **collection** fills visibly: 22 majors and four suits of 14.
- At 3 cards the **daily draw** opens: one card a day from your own deck.
- The draw brings players back, and the home screen's Play button is one tap away.

Session shape. Open the app → daily draw (30 s) → one to three levels (2 to 8 min) → close. Nothing decays while the player is away, so a missed day costs nothing.

THE BOARD

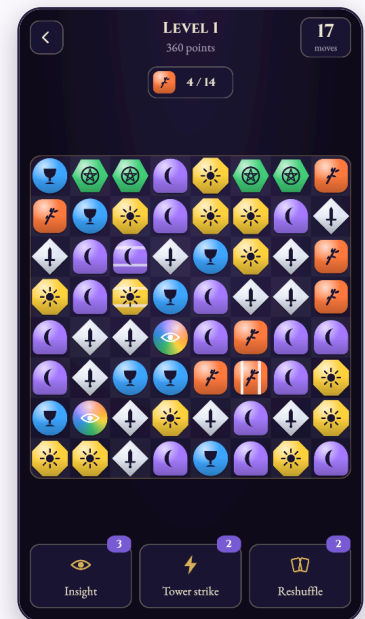
Genre-standard rules, with every edge case resolved in the player's favour.

TILE	SHAPE	ROLE
	Wands	Orange rounded square
	Cups	Blue circle
	Swords	Silver diamond
	Pentacles	Green hexagon
	Moon	Violet arch
	Sun	Gold octagon

Four suits carry the theme and the goals. Moon and Sun never appear in goals: they exist so that only about a third of the board is ever the target suit, which makes goals take real effort.

RULES

RULE	VALUE	WHY
Grid	8 x 8	Genre standard; fits a phone's width at a comfortable touch size.
Starting board	No matches, no 2 x 2 squares, at least one valid move	The first move is always the player's choice, never a free cascade.
Input	Swipe toward a neighbour, or tap two neighbours	Swipe is fast; tap-tap is precise and more accessible.
Invalid swap	Tiles slide over and back with a head-shake	Costs no move: a mis-swipe should never be punished.
No valid moves	Automatic gather-and-deal reshuffle	A dead board is the game's fault, so the game fixes it.
Scoring	tiles cleared x 10 x combo	Combo rises by 1 with each cascade, so chains pay more.
Goal counting	Every cleared tile of a goal suit counts, including cascades and specials	Rewards reading the board over grinding single matches.
Refill odds	Goal suits are 1.4x more likely (see chapter 7)	Keeps large late-game goals reachable.



Level 1: goal pill, move counter, 8 x 8 board, booster bar

SPECIAL TILES

Harder shapes make stronger tiles, and every special can set off the others.

SHAPE	MADE BY	SPECIAL	EFFECT
 Line of 5+		Arcana tile <i>spinning rainbow with an eye</i>	Swap with any tile: clears every tile of that type, scored x2. Swap two Arcana: clears the board. Hit by another effect: clears the most common type.
 L or T shape (5+)		Star <i>four-point star of light</i>	Clears its whole row and column.
 Line of 4		Row / column clearer <i>stripes</i>	A horizontal 4 makes a column clearer, a vertical 4 a row clearer: the beam crosses the line you made, reaching fresh tiles.
 2 x 2 square		Wheel <i>a slowly turning ring of beads</i>	Clears the 3 x 3 block around it.

MAKING SPECIALS FEEL FAIR

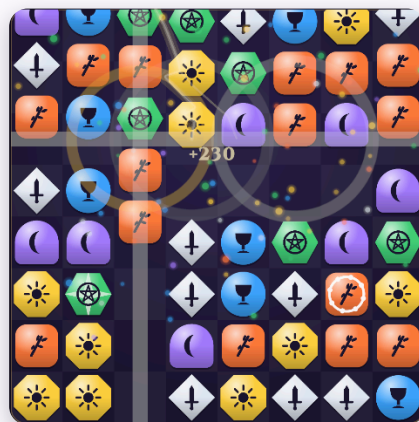
- **Priority:** when shapes overlap, the rarer special wins: Arcana > Star > line clearer > Wheel. A harder shape is never “downgraded”.
- **Aim:** a special made by the player's swap appears on the swapped cell, so it can be placed on purpose. Cascade-made specials appear in the middle of the shape (the corner of an L).
- **Chains:** effects travel through other specials. A Star crossing a Wheel fires it, which can hit an Arcana tile, and so on. Each special fires once per chain, so chains always end.
- **Readable:** each special has a distinct overlay, motion and sound, so the player learns them by sight and ear, without a tutorial screen.

Playtest change. The prototype only rewarded straight lines of 4 and 5, so specials were rare and every player met the same two. Squares and L/T shapes are common on a match-3 board, so adding the Wheel and the Star gave players more ways to aim for a special and more variety in what the board does.

The orientation rule for line clearers is deliberate: the beam crosses the line the player just made, so it reaches new tiles instead of a row that is already emptying.



Specials waiting on the board: two Stars (four-point light) and a Wheel (bead ring, right)



A Star fires: row and column beams, rings, sparks and a +230 floater



An Arcana tile fires: violet lightning to every tile of one type

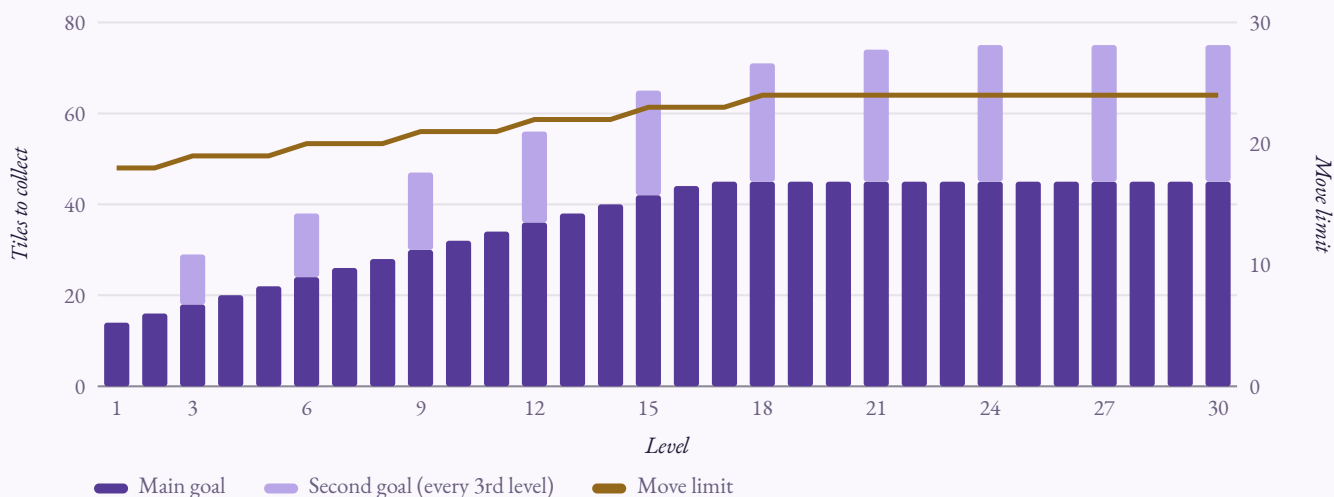
LEVELS AND DIFFICULTY

An endless curve generated from three formulas, so every level exists without hand-authoring.

```
goal      = min(12 + 2n, 45)
           tiles of suit[(n - 1) mod 4]
2nd goal  = min(8 + n, 30)
           of suit[n mod 4], every 3rd
level
moves     = 18 + min(floor(n / 3), 6)
```

- Goals grow by 2 tiles a level; moves grow by 1 every 3 levels, so pressure (tiles per move) rises smoothly.
- Caps (45 tiles, 30 for the second goal, 24 moves) stop it running away after level 17.
- Every 3rd level adds a second suit: a **spike**. The next level has one goal again: a **breather**.
- The suit rotates each level, so the player never chases the same colour twice in a row.

DIFFICULTY CURVE, LEVELS 1 TO 30



THE FIRST TWELVE LEVELS

LEVEL	GOALS	MOVES	TILES PER MOVE	CARD REWARD
1	14 Wands	18	0.78	The Fool
2	16 Cups	18	0.89	Random Cups
3	18 Swords + 11 Pentacles	19	1.53	Random Swords
4	20 Pentacles	19	1.05	Random major
5	22 Wands	19	1.16	Random Wands
6	24 Cups + 14 Swords	20	1.90	Random Cups
7	26 Swords	20	1.30	Random Swords
8	28 Pentacles	20	1.40	Random major
9	30 Wands + 17 Cups	21	2.24	Random Wands
10	32 Cups	21	1.52	Random Cups
11	34 Swords	21	1.62	Random Swords
12	36 Pentacles + 20 Wands	22	2.55	Random major

BALANCING WITH A SIMULATOR

A bot plays the real game rules thousands of times, so tuning decisions rest on data instead of feel alone.

The problem. Playtesting showed late levels could stall. With every tile type equally likely, each suit is only 1 in 6 of new tiles, and a late goal of 45 + 26 tiles outgrew what the board delivered in 24 moves.

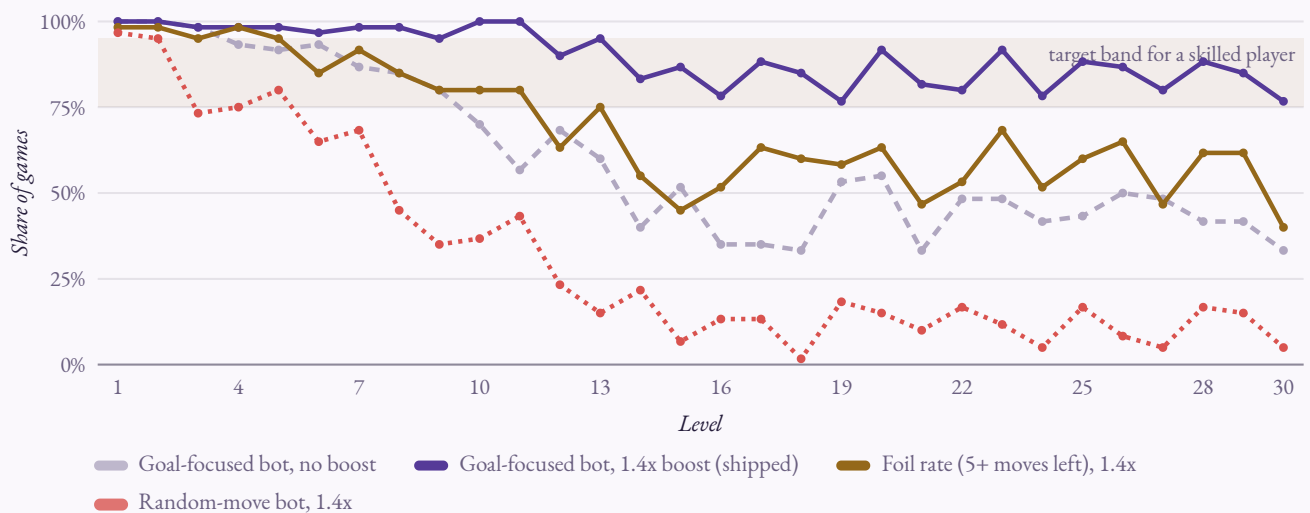
The method. `LevelSimulator` runs the shipped rules (same resolver, same cascades and specials) with two bots: a *goal-focused* bot that picks the move clearing the most goal tiles, standing in for a skilled player, and a *random* bot as a floor. Each point is 60 games.

The fix. Goal suits spawn with extra weight, on the starting board and in refills. A sweep of weights (below) chose **1.4x**: a single goal suit rises from 17% to 22% of new tiles, enough to keep goals reachable without the board feeling rigged.

LEVEL	NO BOOST	1.4X	FOIL	RANDOM
3	98%	98%	95%	73%
9	80%	95%	80%	35%
15	52%	87%	45%	7%
18	33%	85%	60%	2%
24	42%	78%	52%	5%
30	33%	77%	40%	5%

Goal-focused bot win rates without and with the boost; foil rate and random bot at 1.4x.

WIN AND FOIL RATES BY LEVEL



BOOST SWEEP: WHICH WEIGHT HITS THE TARGETS?



Targets. Early levels near-certain; late levels a real challenge for a skilled player (about 75 to 95%); foil clearly harder than a win; random play fails most late levels. At 1.0x late levels fell to 33 to 42%; above 1.5x they became trivial and goals stopped shaping decisions.

BOOSTERS, WINNING AND LOSING

Boosters are tools, not a toll: none of them costs a move, and the dangerous one has a safety catch.

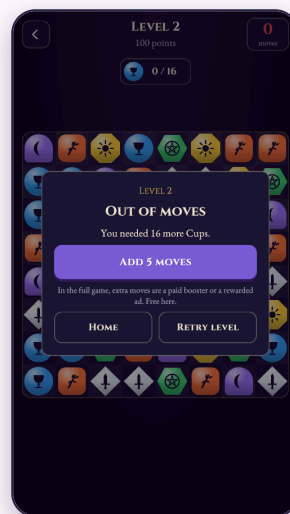
BOOSTER	START	EFFECT	DESIGN ROLE
Insight	3	Board dims, an eye opens, two orbs fly to a valid move, which pulses	Removes frustration when stuck and quietly teaches patterns.
Tower Strike	2	Armed first (gold frame + prompt); tap a tile and lightning clears its 3 x 3, firing specials	Finish a goal or break a stubborn corner. Arming prevents a wasted stray tap.
Reshuffle	2	Tiles spin to the centre and are dealt out again	A fresh board when the layout looks hopeless.



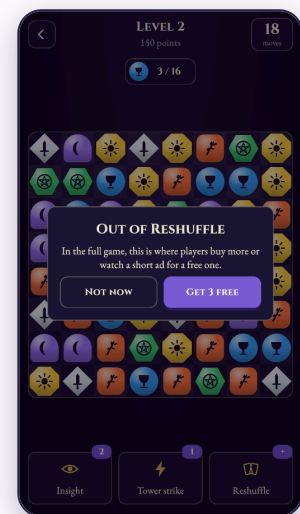
Insight



Tower Strike armed



Lose: what was missing



Refill: the store hook

WIN, LOSE AND THE RESCUE

- **Win is checked before lose**, so completing the goals on the last move is a win.
- Winning with **5 or more moves left** earns the foil card: optional mastery on top of the goal.
- Progress only moves forward: replaying an old level never lowers it.
- The lose screen says exactly what was missing (*You needed 3 more Cups*).
- **Add 5 moves** is offered once per attempt, then Retry or Home.
- An empty booster shows +; tapping it opens the refill screen (+3, free in this build).

THE COLLECTION META

The reward for a level is a card you keep. The deck is the player's record of their journey.



THE DECK

All 78 tarot cards: 22 major arcana and 56 minor (Ace to Ten, Page, Knight, Queen and King in four suits). Every card has original art generated from code (new emblems for all majors and court cards, an arched night-sky window tinted per card) and a one-line insight. The middle card is a foil edition.

IX · THE HERMIT

Some time alone will help you think clearly.

XVI · THE TOWER

A sudden shake-up can clear the way for something truer.

XIX · THE SUN

Warmth and small joys are on your side today.

UNLOCK RULES

LEVEL	CARD POOL
1	The Fool, the traditional start of the tarot journey
Every 4th	A random major arcana you don't own: chapter markers
Others	A random card of the level's suit you don't own
Pool empty	Falls back to the suit, then to any missing card

Playtest change. The prototype dealt cards in a fixed order, so every deck looked the same and the next reward was predictable. Random draws within each pool keep the structure (majors as milestones, suits matching the level) while making each unlock a small surprise and each player's collection their own.

Foil is earned by winning with 5+ moves left: an animated rainbow frame and a sweeping shine. A card never loses its foil, so skilled replays add value without undoing progress.

78 wins complete the deck, and no level ever gives a duplicate (checked by an automated test that plays all 78).

Open issue, found in the card catalogue spreadsheet. The suit rotation (4 suits) lines up with the major cadence (every 4th level), so every Pentacles level gives a major and Pentacles cards only arrive late, through the fallback. Proposed fix: majors every 5th level, so each suit gets its own card levels.

DAILY DRAW

Unlocks at 3 cards. Once per calendar day the player taps a face-down card and it turns over to show a card from **their own** collection, with its insight.

- Drawing from owned cards makes the collection matter: a bigger deck means a more varied draw.
- One draw a day and **no streak to lose**: a reason to return that never punishes a missed day.
- The draw sits one tap from Play, so the ritual leads naturally into a level.



ECONOMY AND MONETISATION

Designed as optional time-savers on top of a game that is completely finishable for free. **PROPOSED**

RESOURCES

RESOURCE	SOURCE (FREE)	SINK	STATUS
Moves	Level's move limit (18 to 24)	One per accepted swap	LIVE
+5 moves	Once per attempt on the lose screen	Continues the level	LIVE, FREE
Insight / Tower Strike / Reshuffle	3 / 2 / 2 at start; +3 per refill	One per use; never costs a move	LIVE, FREE
Cards	One per level won	None: cards are never spent	LIVE
Foil	Win with 5+ moves left	None: permanent	LIVE

MONETISATION HOOKS

HOOK	MOMENT	REWARDED AD	PURCHASE (PROPOSED PRICE)
Extra moves	Lose screen, once per attempt	Watch for +5 moves	+5 moves, US\$0.99
Booster refill	Tapping an empty booster	Watch for +1	Bundle of 3, US\$1.99; mixed pack of 9, US\$4.99
Card sleeves (cosmetic)	Collection screen	No	Alternative card backs, US\$2.99
Remove ads	Settings	n/a	One-time US\$3.99

ETHICAL GUARDRAILS

- No energy or lives system: the player can always play the next level.
- No card can be bought. Every card is earned by play; the collection stays honest.
- No forced interstitials mid-level; ads are always opt-in and rewarded.
- One rescue per attempt, so the lose screen is not a paywall loop.

IMPLEMENTATION

Every purchase and ad goes through `IStoreService` and `IAdService`. The build ships a placeholder that grants everything for free, so the whole flow (lose → offer → success → +5 moves) is already testable. Swapping in a real store is one class, with no gameplay changes.

Prices are placeholders to validate in a soft launch, not tested numbers.

UX, SCREENS AND ACCESSIBILITY

Two screens and a handful of panels: the player is never more than one tap from playing.



SCREEN MAP

SCREEN / PANEL	PURPOSE	KEY ACTIONS
Home	Title, card fan, progress	Play level n · Collection (x of 78) · Daily draw · Sound · Reset
Level	The puzzle	HUD: back, level and score, moves; goal pills; board; booster bar
Win panel	Celebrate and reward	Card flips in, insight, foil note · Next level · Home
Lose panel	Explain and rescue	What was missing · Add 5 moves (once) · Retry · Home
Refill panel	Store hook	Buy / watch for +3 · Close
Collection	The deck	Majors and four suits with counts; locked slots; tap for detail
Daily draw	Ritual	Locked (N more) · Face-down card · Today's card

LAYOUT

- Portrait at a 1080 x 1920 reference; scales to any phone.
- Respects the safe area (notches, cutouts, the home bar).
- The board sizes itself to the space the HUD leaves, so it's as large as possible on every screen.
- Thumb zone: boosters at the bottom, information at the top.

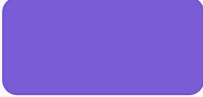
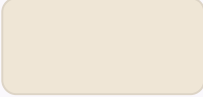
ACCESSIBILITY

- Colour, shape and glyph on every tile: three independent cues.
- Touch targets of at least 106 px at the reference size.
- Tap-tap as an alternative to swiping.
- No timers anywhere; a mute toggle that is saved.

ART DIRECTION

A tarot deck read by candlelight: deep night sky, antique gold, and jewel-bright tiles that glow against it.

PALETTE

					
Night #110d1d Background	Panel #1d1733 Cards, panels	Accent #7a5cd6 Buttons, focus	Gold #d9b35c Frames, success	Parchment #efe6d6 Text	Muted #a99fbd Secondary text

TILES: COLOUR, SILHOUETTE AND GLYPH



Wands
#ff7a3d



Cups
#3da5ff



Swords
#c9d2e3



Pentacles
#43d17a



Moon
#a57cff



Sun
#ffd23f

TYPOGRAPHY

CINZEL BOLD

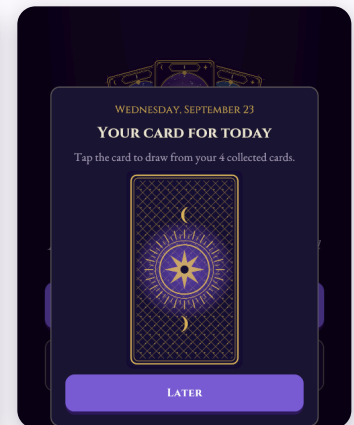
Titles, card names, buttons. Roman inscriptional capitals suit the tarot's classical imagery.

EB Garamond Italic

Body text and insights. A book face that reads well small and feels like a printed guidebook. Both are SIL Open Font License.

CARDS

Each card is composed at runtime from shared layers (sky window tinted per card, one of four star fields, hills, halo, emblem or pips, ornate frame, cartouche and banner with live text) instead of 78 full images: about 90 MB saved, and every card stays consistent.



PRINCIPLES

- Dark theme only: tiles and effects read best against the night sky, and it's easy on the eyes at night.
- Light is the reward: every positive event adds glow, sparks or a beam.
- All art is original and generated by editor scripts, so it can be restyled consistently.

THE MAJOR ARCANA IN THE COLLECTION: EACH CARD'S SKY IS TINTED ALONG A COLOUR WHEEL



AUDIO

Every sound and the music are original, synthesized from code, so the whole soundscape can be re-tuned in minutes.

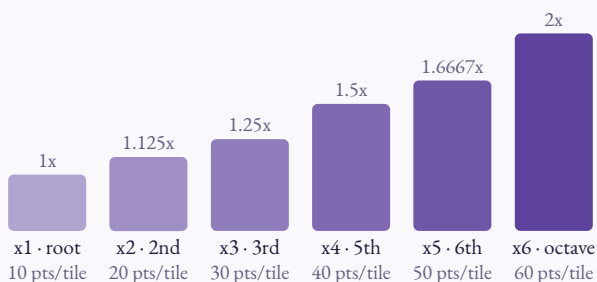
EVENT	SOUND	INTENT
Match	FM glass bell; pitch climbs a pentatonic step per cascade	Rewards chains audibly; pentatonic never clashes
Special made	Rising arpeggio	Tells the player they made something
Line / Star beam	Bright zing	Sells the sweep of light
Wheel	Deep thump (the thunder, pitched down)	A weighty local blast with a small board shake
Arcana	Electric crackle; for two, a swelling rush and boom	The biggest moment gets the biggest sound
Tower Strike	Thunder	Matches the lightning bolt
Insight	Upward sparkle	Magical, helpful
Reshuffle	Card riffle	A real deck being shuffled
Card flip / foil	Swish / glitter	The reward reveal
Win / lose	Blooming chord / three soft falling notes	Disappointing, never harsh (the gentle pillar)
Invalid swap	Two soft wooden bonks	A gentle "nope", never a buzzer

MUSIC: "NIGHT SKY"

A 32-second seamless ambient loop (D minor, B flat, G minor, A) with sparse bells and an echo. It sits quietly under the effects so chimes stay readable.

THE COMBO SCALE

Combo x1 plays the root; x2 a whole tone higher; x3 a major third; x4 a fifth, and so on up the scale. A long cascade audibly builds, which makes chains feel earned.



IMPLEMENTATION

- `SoundGenerator` writes every WAV: FM bells, filtered noise, a plucked riffle and a soft pad.
- `AudioService` pools voices, applies combo pitch, and keeps the music under the effects.
- Mix levels and pitches live in the `SoundBank` asset.
- A speaker button on Home mutes everything; the setting is saved.

GAME FEEL

Timings were found in the browser prototype and carried over exactly; all of them live in one tuning asset.

MOMENT	FEEDBACK	TIMING
Swap	Tiles glide on a cubic-bezier(.25, .8, .35, 1) curve	0.26 s move, 0.21 s beat
Invalid swap	Slide over, slide back, head-shake	0.25 s shake
Clear	Tiles grow to 135% and fade; coloured sparks; +points and Combo x n float up	0.2 s pop, 0.22 s beat
Fall and refill	New tiles drop in from above the board	0.3 s
Special created	White ring pulse where it appears	0.2 s
Line / Star clear	A band of light sweeps the row and/or column	0.45 s
Wheel	White ring, gold sparks, a small board shake	0.4 s ring, 0.25 s shake
Arcana	Violet lightning arcs to every target; they flicker, then clear together	0.38 s wind-up
Tower Strike	Board dims, jagged bolt, white flash, shake, rings, sparks	about 0.41 s to the clear
Insight	Board dims, an eye opens, two orbs fly to the hinted tiles	about 1.3 s
Reshuffle	Tiles spin into the centre, then are dealt back out one by one	0.36 s gather, 0.42 s deal
Card unlock	Card turns over, then its insight fades in	flip at 0.45 s, text at 1.1 s

HUD FEEDBACK

- Goal pills bump when they progress and turn gold with a tick when met.
- Goal counters fill *as each clear animates*, not at the end of the turn, so a cascade visibly pays out.
- The move counter pulses on change and turns red at 5.
- Specials use distinct motion: the Arcana tile spins, the Wheel slowly turns, stripes shimmer.

Why a tuning asset? A designer can change any timing during Play mode and feel the difference immediately, without touching code or waiting for a compile.



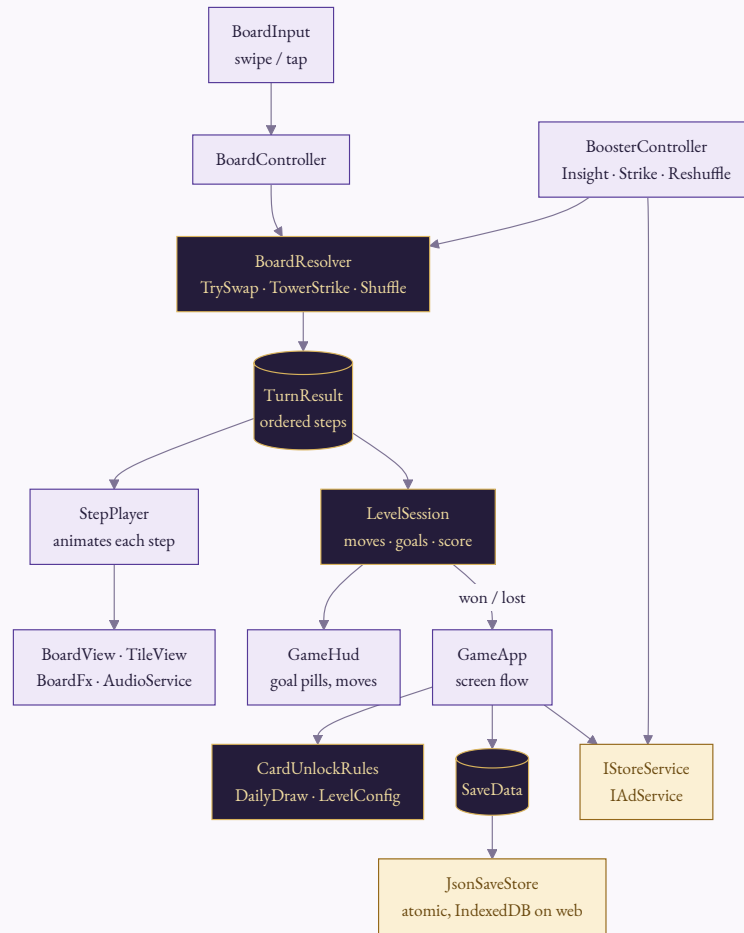
Arcana blast: lightning to every target



Tower Strike

TECHNICAL DESIGN

Rules in plain C#, animation as playback: the design stays testable and the view can never disagree with the rules.



KEY DECISIONS

- **The model never waits for animation.** A move resolves instantly into an ordered list of steps (swap, clear, special created, fall, shuffle, blast); **StepPlayer** animates them.
- **Deterministic rules.** Randomness is injected (**IRandom**), so tests and the balance simulator are repeatable.
- **Data-driven.** Cards, tile looks, timings and sounds are assets a designer can edit.
- **No third-party packages.** Tweening, effects and shaders are small in-house pieces.

QUALITY AND TOOLING

- **106 EditMode tests** cover matching, generation, cascades, all specials and chains, spawn odds, boosters, levels, card unlocks (all 78 without a duplicate), the daily draw and saving.
- **Reproducible project:** art, fonts, the 78-card deck, sounds and the main scene are generated by editor menu items.
- **Builds:** one-click Android APK and a mobile web build (safe area, portrait prompt, home-screen install, saves in IndexedDB) for playtesters on any phone.

PLAYTESTING AND ITERATION

Built in six checkpointed phases; each one was played and steered before the next was built on top of it.

1 · PLAN Prototype study, architecture, design pillars	2 · BOARD Matching, cascades, swipe and tap, animation playback	3 · LEVELS Goals, moves, HUD, win and lose flow	4 · FEEL Specials, boosters, particles, beams, lightning	5 · META 78 cards, collection, daily draw, foil, saving	6 · SHIP Android and web builds, sound, tuning
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WHAT TESTING CHANGED

OBSERVATION	CHANGE	HOW IT WAS CHECKED
Late levels could stall: not enough goal tiles appeared.	Goal suits spawn 1.4x more often, on the starting board and in refills.	Balance simulator: win rate at level 18 rose from 33% to 85%; sweep chose the weight.
Specials were rare and always the same two.	Added the Wheel (2 x 2 square) and the Star (L/T shape), with a clear priority order.	Unit tests for every shape, overlap and chain; play sessions.
Every player got the same cards in the same order.	Random draws within each pool (majors every 4th level, the level's suit otherwise).	Test plays all 78 levels: complete deck, no duplicates.
The game felt flat without sound.	Synthesized effects for every event and a music loop; chimes climb with the combo.	Listening passes in the editor; combo pitch checked.
Tapping a tile mid-refill could leave a see-through gap.	Input is blocked per tile until it lands.	Reproduced in the editor and fixed.
Testers on iPhone could not install an APK.	Mobile web build with home-screen install and saved progress.	Checked in iPhone and Android phone emulation; saves persist.

PLAYTEST PLAN FOR THE NEXT ROUND

- 5 to 8 players, mixed match-3 experience, on their own phones via the web build.
- Silent first session (no instructions): do they discover specials and boosters?
- Watch for: first stuck moment, first booster use, reaction to the first card.
- Short survey: clarity of goals, difficulty by level, favourite special, would they return for the draw?
- Log per level: result, moves left, boosters used, extra moves taken.
- Compare real win rates with the simulator's to calibrate it.

ROADMAP, KPIS AND RISKS

What would come next if this vertical slice went into production.

NEXT	WHAT	WHY
Analytics	Level start / win / lose, moves left, booster use, extra-moves uptake, daily-draw return	Tune the curve on real players, not only the bot.
Level variety	Blockers (veiled tiles that need two clears), fixed layouts for major-arcana levels, goals that ask for specials	Keeps levels 20+ fresh when the formula alone flattens out.
Special combos	Swap two specials: Star + Wheel = three-wide cross; line + Arcana = every tile of a type becomes a line clearer	Genre-expected depth and big moments.
Card journal	Note how each daily card related to your day	Deepens the ritual for the secondary audience.
Haptics and localisation	Light vibration on matches, stronger on specials; card text is already in data	Feel on device; reach.

KPIS FOR A SOFT LAUNCH

METRIC	QUESTION	TARGET
D1 / D7 / D30	Does the daily draw bring people back?	40 / 15 / 6%
Levels per session	Is one more level tempting?	3+
Level fail rate	Is any level a wall?	< 50% at any level
Extra-moves uptake	Is the rescue valued without feeling forced?	10 to 20% of losses
Daily-draw use	Is the ritual working?	50% of D1+ players

Targets are planning assumptions to validate, not measured results.

RISKS

RISK	MITIGATION
The theme alienates some players	Tarot as art and reflection, never fortune-telling; kind, general insights.
Late levels feel the same	Blockers, layouts and special goals (above); curve checked by the simulator.
Collection ends at 78	Foil completion, card sleeves, seasonal decks as live content.
A crowded genre	Differentiate on reward, tone and ritual rather than on rules.

Credits. Design, code and art direction: Umut Eren Demirci. Built in Unity 6 with the help of Claude (Anthropic) as a coding assistant. Fonts: Cinzel (Natanael Gama) and EB Garamond (Georg Duffner, Octavio Pardo), SIL Open Font License. All other art, sound and music are original and generated by the project's editor scripts.